

Micro life

Most living things are made up of just one cell, and are too small to see. To study them we must use powerful microscopes.

Bacteria

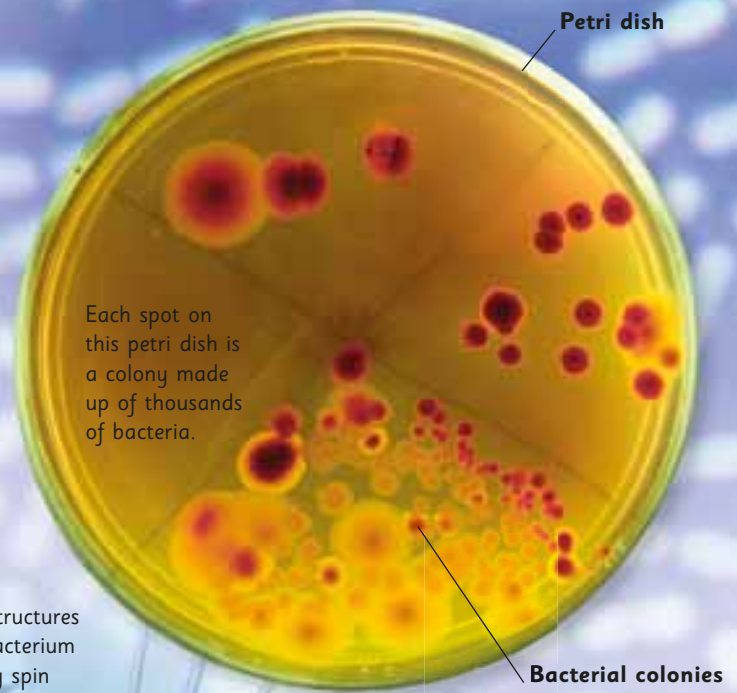
Bacteria are single-celled life forms. They are found in the ocean, in the air, and even in our bodies. They can reproduce very quickly by splitting in two. Some bacteria can make energy from sunlight. However, most feed on dead plants and animals.

Harmful bacteria

Some bacteria can cause serious illnesses such as cholera and tetanus. Good sanitation and antibiotic drugs help fight diseases caused by harmful bacteria.



Bacteria may be shaped like rods, spirals, or spheres.



Each spot on this petri dish is a colony made up of thousands of bacteria.

Whip-like structures push the bacterium along. They spin round like screws.

Bacterial colonies

Model of a bacterium

Thin hairs attach the bacterium to a surface.

The cell is full of a jelly-like substance that helps it to work and grow.

The bacterium's DNA code is held in the nucleus.

The cell wall holds the bacterium together and protects it.

Good bacteria

Some bacteria are helpful to humans. Bacteria in our guts protect us from illnesses. Other bacteria are used to make foods such as yoghurt and cheese.

